Artificial Intelligence Training Program Certification Standards

Fiscal Year 2026-2027

Government Code Section 2054.5193 requires the Department of Information Resources (DIR), in consultation with the Public Sector AI Systems Advisory Board, to certify AI training programs that meet certain minimum requirements. DIR will assess programs submitted for certification using the following list of required topics.

AI Training Program Required Content

General Explanation of AI & How Public Sector Employees Can Use AI

- A basic overview of what AI is.
- Practical and relevant use cases for AI in the public sector, such as automating workflows, analyzing data, summarizing documents, and communicating with constituents by using chatbots.
- Examples of common AI tools that government employees may use in their employment and for what purposes those tools are appropriate.
- Emphasis that employees must only use AI tools as authorized by their employers.

Risks and Limitations of AI

- Recognition that AI has limitations and that its use may involve some risk. Some tools and use cases are riskier than others.
    - AI is not always accurate and may reflect outdated information.
    - The value of AI depends in part on the quality of its training data.
    - Sometimes AI lacks judgment or contextual awareness relative to human capability.
- Mitigation measures can be implemented that correspond with the risk an AI tool presents.
- Explanation that laws may prohibit using AI for certain actions, including social scoring or identifying individuals based on biometric data gathered without the individual's consent. AI use must not conflict with any state or federal laws or regulations.

Best Practices for the Responsible and Ethical Use of AI

- Emphasis on guiding principles for responsible and ethical AI deployment and use, including:
    - Human Oversight – Ensure AI outputs are reviewed and that systems can be adjusted if use of the tool results in negative impacts.
    - Privacy and Security – Protect individuals' personal information when using AI and never input personal or sensitive information into publicly available tools.
    - Transparency – Provide notice to consumers when they interact with AI or when using AI to make consequential decisions.
    - Accuracy – Verify outputs for correctness and establish processes for monitoring AI results.
    - Accountability – Understand that governments are responsible for decisions made by AI.

Program Format and Features

DIR strongly recommends, but does not require, that training programs contain the following:

- An assessment of learning outcomes.
- Proof of completion.
- Compliance with accessibility standards.